

‘A test case’ for troop call-up

Bass and others worry the Guard role in D.C. hints at Trump’s intent for the L.A. Olympics.

By HANNAH FRY, DAKOTA SMITH, RICHARD WINTON AND ANDREA CASTILLO

President Trump’s decision to deploy hundreds of National Guard troops to Washington has California officials on high alert, with some worrying that he intends to activate federal forces in the Bay Area and Southern California, especially during the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

Trump said that his use of the National Guard to fight crime could expand to other cities, and suggested that local police have been unable to do the job.

Legal experts say it is highly unusual and troubling for forces to be deployed without a major crisis, such as civil unrest or a natural disaster. The Washington deployment is another example of Trump seeking to use the military for domestic endeavors, similar to his decision to send the National Guard to Los Angeles in June, amid an immigration crackdown that sparked protests, experts said.

Washington has long struggled with crime but has seen major reductions in recent years.

Officials in Oakland and Los Angeles — two cities the president mentioned by name — slammed Trump’s comments about crime in their cities. Oakland Mayor Barbara Lee said in a statement that the president’s characterization wasn’t rooted in fact, but “based in fear-mongering in an attempt to score cheap political points.” Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass called it “performative” and a “stunt.”

Trump has said he would consider deploying the military to Los Angeles once again to protect the 2028 Olympic Games. This month, he signed an executive order that named him chair of a White House task force on the Los Angeles Games.

The White House has not said specifically what role Trump would play in security arrangements.

Los Angeles City Councilmember Imelda Padilla, who sits on the city panel overseeing the Games, acknowledged last week that the city is a “little nervous” [See **Troops**, A7]



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

A RALLY AGAINST IMMIGRATION RAIDS

Hundreds of workers, organizers and immigrant rights activists gather at MacArthur Park to protest Trump administration policies. “Los Angeles is ready to fight,” a union leader says. **BUSINESS, A9**

Is Trump’s deal with 2 chipmakers legal?

National security concerns also raised as Nvidia, AMD agree to pay U.S. 15% of revenue from sales to China

By QUEENIE WONG

President Trump struck an unusual deal with Nvidia and Advanced Micro Devices that allows the companies to sell certain chips to China in exchange for giving the U.S. government a 15% cut of those sales.

But the unprecedented agreement also has raised concerns from politicians and legal experts over whether the deal is legal and would pose a national security threat.

Questions also linger about exactly how the deal, which was announced Monday, would work because the Constitution bars taxes on exports, although some experts said Trump could find a work-around.

The U.S. government might receive \$3 billion from the revenue split if China’s demand for Nvidia’s H20 chip — which is less powerful

than the company’s highest-end artificial intelligence chip — reaches \$20 billion, according to a note from Bernstein Research.

“It ties the fate of this chip manufacturer in a very particular way to this administration that is quite rare,” said Julia Powles, a professor and executive director of the UCLA Institute for Technology, Law & Policy.

Trump’s agreement with the world’s most valuable company could put pressure on other tech companies and major exporters to strike similar deals with the U.S. government, but it’s still unclear what the implications will be internationally, she said.

The deal is the latest example of how tech companies are seeking to curry favor with the Trump administration, which has threatened [See **Chips**, A11]

After fires, scientists doubt lead-in-soil limit

Is the state standard too lax? What survivors should know.

By NOAH HAGGERTY

It’s a number thousands of Palisades and Eaton fire survivors have come to depend on: 80 milligrams of lead in each kilogram of soil.

Below this concentration, California has historically deemed yards safe enough for families to rebuild and move home after a fire. Any more, state scientists say, comes with a notable risk of kids developing neurological problems from the lead they accidentally inhale, absorb through their skin and eat while playing

outside.

In a paper out Friday, Harvard environmental health researchers argue it’s not strict enough. The scientists contend that the state’s health standard is not based on sound science and should sit around 55 milligrams per kilogram of soil (a measure also referred to as “parts per million”) instead.

“We’re getting asked these questions every single day, like every other scientist ... ‘Is it safe for my kids?’” said Joseph Allen, lead author on the paper and a Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health professor who

has been working with fire survivors through the LA Fire HEALTH Study research program. “I can’t look at somebody in the eye anymore, knowing what I know about these models, and tell them yes.”

However, other soil and health researchers said it’s a debate best confined to technical scientific papers, with few implications for fire survivors wondering whether their property is safe.

Here’s what you should know:

Why a stricter standard? Lead can cause negative

health effects at virtually any level of exposure, so scientists at California’s Department of Toxic Substances Control set their health standard for lead in residential soil by starting with a goal: The standard should prevent children from losing one IQ point due to lead exposure.

To answer this, the department uses a computer model, LeadSpread, that estimates how much lead might enter the body of a kid who plays in the dirt, primarily through accidentally eating dirt left on their

[See **Lead**, A14]

Your best bet for stargazing? California, oddsmakers declare

A sports betting site deems the Golden State the top place to view cosmic events.

By KAREN GARCIA

When it comes to exploring the wonders of the night sky, sports betting touts are hardly considered astronomical authorities.

Perhaps that’s why a recent ranking by the betting website Action Network has some local astronomers scratching their heads over a decision to name California the best state in the nation to stargaze.

By the website’s calculation, California topped the list of states, with Colorado,

Oregon, Utah and New Mexico following closely behind.

“The Action Network has analyzed sky visibility, elevation, historical meteor activity, and astronomical infrastructure to compile a ranked list of the best states for witnessing celestial events,” the website announced.

Although professional astronomers acknowledge that California is an ideal location for star parties, they said the list has its flaws.

“The ranking of those places doesn’t necessarily make any sense at all and is probably based on a variety of assumptions, maybe some judgment involved about which of those states have more dark sky territory

[See **Cosmic**, A7]



RAUL ROA Los Angeles Times

A TIME-LAPSE exposure at Joshua Tree National Park shows star trails in 2020.

Schools to block ICE, protect pupils

LAUSD expands its aggressive defense of immigrant families as school year begins.

By HOWARD BLUME

Los Angeles public schools are opening Thursday for the new academic year confronting an intense and historically unique moment: They will be operating in opposition to the federal government’s immigration raids and have set in motion aggressive moves to protect children and their immigrant parents.

School police and officers from several municipal forces will patrol near some 100 schools, setting up “safe zones” in heavily Latino neighborhoods, with a special concentration at high schools where older Latino students are walking to campus. Bus routes are being changed to better serve areas with immigrant families so children can get to school with less exposure to immigration agents.

Community volunteers will join district staff and contractors to serve as scouts — alerting campuses of nearby enforcement actions so schools can be locked down as warranted and parents and others in the school community can be quickly notified via email and text.

L.A. Mayor Karen Bass spoke about “how profound this moment is in U.S. history” during a Monday news conference with local officials.

“Here you have an entire array of elected officials, appointed officials, education leaders, people committed to our children, and we are gathered here today to talk about protecting our children from the federal government,” Bass said.

[See **Schools**, A8]

LAPD struggles to draw Black recruits

By LIBOR JANY

Convincing young Black people to become cops has long been a tough sell at summer job fairs.

But in recent months, the pool of recruits at the Los Angeles Police Department has shriveled to the point of running dry. The last two training academy classes haven’t included a single Black graduate.

Despite offering generous pay and pensions, police agencies across the country have struggled since the COVID-19 pandemic with finding enough new officers, regardless of race.

At the Los Angeles Police Department, the number of Black recruits — especially women — has been dropping for years, leaving the department far short of diversity goals put in place decades ago to counter discriminatory hiring practices.

Compounding matters is President Trump, who has embarked on a far-reaching campaign against diversity, equity and inclusion, or so-called DEI policies.

LAPD Chief Jim McDonnell quietly shut down the department’s DEI program during an administrative reshuffling this year. Massive cuts to federal agencies and university programs have [See **LAPD**, A8]

U.S. inflation holds steady

Consumer prices are up 2.7%, a modest increase from a year earlier. **BUSINESS, A9**

Judge won’t clear convicted deputy

Trevor Kirk will go to prison, despite pressure from the U.S. attorney. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

UCLA seeking ways to fill bowl

In an effort to increase attendance at the Rose Bowl, Bruins need to get creative. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 82/65. **B6**

Markets

Opinion Voices **A12**

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